פרי צדיק

Pri Tzaddik

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Rosh Chodesh to Tu BiShvat

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin
(1823–1900)

✦

SELECTED TEACHINGS

Mar Cheshvan · Kislev · Chanukah · Shevat

AKIVA PUBLISHING

Pri Tzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition · Rosh Chodesh to Tu BiShvat

This volume presents selected teachings of Pri Tzaddik in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in footnotes. The selection includes Rosh Chodesh; Rosh Chodesh Mar Cheshvan; Rosh Chodesh Kislev, ois 1–7; Chanukah, ois 1–25; Rosh Chodesh Shevat, ois 1–6; and Tu BiShvat, ois 1–5.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

Original work פרי צדיק by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

Interlinear translation, vocalization, original source translations, annotations, and editorial apparatus © 2026 Akiva Publishing. All rights reserved in the original editorial material. No part of that material may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying and recording, without permission from the publisher, except for brief quotations in reviews. Retained third-party source translations are credited separately under their respective terms in the Source Translation Credits. No claim of exclusive rights is made to those source editions.

Published by Akiva Publishing · First Edition, 2026

Rosh Chodesh

Rosh Chodesh and the Renewal of Israel

God sanctifies Israel and entrusts the sanctification of the month to them. Rav Tzadok reads the language of holiness above as something God chooses to establish through Israel's holiness and praise.

Rosh Chodesh and the Renewal of Israel

קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ הִיא מִצְוָה רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁנִּתְּנָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם,[1] — **Sanctification of the New Moon is the first commandment given to Israel in Egypt,** וְלֹא נֶאֱמְרָה לָהֶם רַק לְמֹשֶׁה וּלְאַהֲרֹן, — **and it was not spoken directly to them, but only to Moses and Aaron,** וְלֹא אָמַר שֶׁיֹּאמְרוּ זֶה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **and He did not state that they should say this to all Israel;** – "הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם" — אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם — **nonetheless, 'This month shall be unto you'—** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת פָּרָשָׁה טו): רְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **means unto the whole of Israel, and as stated in the Midrash Rabbah (Shemot, Parashah 15):** "רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים לָכֶם" וְכוּ'. — **'The New Moon is unto you, etc.'** רַק הַקִּדּוּשׁ נִמְסַר לִגְדוֹלֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַד,[2] — **Only the formal sanctification was entrusted to the leaders of Israel alone,** וְאִם גְּדוֹל הַדּוֹר בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ שֶׁלֹּא הִגִּיעַ כְּמוֹתוֹ בָּאָרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל — **and if the preeminent authority of the generation is in the Diaspora, having left no equal in the Land of Israel,** מְקַדֵּשׁ וְקוֹבֵעַ שָׁם, — **he sanctifies and fixes the month there,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא (בְּרָכוֹת סג.).[3] — **as is related regarding Rabbi Akiva (Berakhot 63a).** וְעַכְשָׁיו קוֹבְעִין עַל פִּי הַקִּדּוּשׁ שֶׁל הִלֵּל הָאַחֲרוֹן, כַּיָּדוּעַ. — **And nowadays we establish it based upon the sanctified calendar of Hillel the Latter, as is known.**

Israel's sanctification gives expression to heavenly holiness

וְהֵיינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שָׁם:[4] — **And this is just as is stated in the Midrash there:** כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לֹא רָצָה לְקַדֵּשׁ — **that Hashem did not desire to sanctify it Himself,** – דְּמִקַּדֵּשׁ לְעַצְמוֹ – — —**for that would be sanctifying for Himself—** רַק הוּא מְקַדֵּשׁ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **rather, He sanctifies Israel,** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהֵם קְדוֹשִׁים[5] — **and by virtue of their being holy,** כְּמוֹ כְּלִי חוֹל מַה שֶּׁהֵם מְקַדְּשִׁין הוּא מְקוּדָּשׁ, — **whatever they sanctify becomes consecrated,** וְעַל כֵּן הֵם מְקַדְּשִׁים אוֹתוֹ, — **like a non-sacred vessel into which one places holy matter.** שֶׁמַּכְנִיס לְתוֹכוֹ קֹדֶשׁ. **Therefore they consecrate it,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהְיִיתֶם לִי קְדֹשִׁים כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי",[6] — **as is stated: 'And you shall be holy unto Me, for I am holy,'** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּמַתְנוֹת כְּהֻנָּה דָּחוּק. — **See the Matnot Kehunah there; its explanation is strained.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּרְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר — **And it appears that the meaning is:** דְּעַל יְדֵי שֶׁאַתֶּם קְדוֹשִׁים, — **that through your being holy,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה "אֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ"; — **thereby 'I am holy';** וְעַל דָּרָךְ זֶה כָּתְבוּ לְפָרֵשׁ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: — **and in this**

---

[1] **Exodus 12:2**: "This month shall be your beginning of months; it shall be the first month of the year to you."

[2] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 2:7**: 'The head of the court says, 'Sanctified!' And all the people answer after him, 'Sanctified, sanctified!' Whether it was seen at the appointed time or was not seen at the appointed time, they sanctify it. Rabbi Elazar son of Rabbi Tzadok says: If it was not seen at the appointed time, they do not sanctify it, for Heaven has already sanctified it."'

[3] **Berakhot 63a**: 'He said to them: Why do I declare impure while you declare pure, and why do I prohibit while you permit? They said to him: Because you intercalate years and establish months outside the Land of Israel. He said to them: But did Rabbi Akiva ben Yosef not intercalate years and establish months outside the Land of Israel? They replied: Leave Rabbi Akiva aside, for he left no one like himself in the Land of Israel. He said: I too left no one like myself in the Land of Israel. They replied: The kids you left have become strong goats with horns; they have sent us to you.'

[4] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 61:2**: "That is: kodesh, written without a vav, indicates the source of holiness, which does not need to receive holiness from another. Kadosh, written with a vav, indicates that it is summoned from kodesh: it must draw holiness from the source. It is unlike kodesh without a vav, which indicates holiness in its own right. As things appear, Israel are called kadosh with a vav, because they must draw holiness to themselves from its blessed source; kodesh would belong to the blessed God alone, the source of holiness. Yet because Israel surrender their entire grasp to God, it becomes clear that they arose in thought above the grasp of creation: their root is in the holiness that is higher than all, holy in its own right. Therefore it is written, 'Israel is kodesh to the Lord.' Moreover, through Israel's service, a vav is drawn above, as the holy Zohar explains: when Israel sanctify, they raise the supreme glory from below to above, until the vav, the mystery of the upper heavens, ascends. When those heavens rise above, that kodesh shines into them, and then it is called kadosh above. The blessed God is called kadosh with a vav: God says that the honor of Heaven is, as it were, incomplete without Israel's service, and only through Israel's service will the honor of Heaven be completed."
Sod Yesharim explains the apparent reversal in Rav Tzadok's reading. Israel receive holiness from its source, yet their surrender and service disclose a holiness rooted above their present understanding. God chooses to describe the manifestation of heavenly honor as completed through that service. The passage's 'as it were' is essential to the way it speaks of God's holiness being established through Israel. This supplies the conceptual basis for entrusting sanctification to people.

[5] **Shemot Rabbah 15:24**: 'Some of the Sages say the blessing is, 'Blessed is He Who renews the months'; others say, 'Blessed is He Who sanctifies the months'; and others say, 'Who sanctifies Israel.' For if Israel do not sanctify it, its sanctification is nothing. Do not wonder at this: the Holy One, blessed be He, sanctified Israel."'

[6] **Leviticus 20:26**: 'You shall be holy to Me, for I, Hashem, am holy; I have separated you from the peoples to be Mine.'

manner commentators explained that which is taught: – "קְדוּשָׁתִי לְמַעְלָה מִקְּדוּשַׁתְכֶם**" — 'My holiness is above your holiness'—** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁתְכֶם אֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ מִלְמַעְלָה.[7] **— that through your holiness I am holy Above.** וְנֶאֱמַר: "וְאַתָּה קָדוֹשׁ יוֹשֵׁב תְּהִלּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל",[8] **— And it is said: 'Yet You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel,'** רְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר עַל יְדֵי תְּהִלּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, עַיֵּין שָׁם. **— meaning, established through the praises of Israel, see there.** הַכַּוָּנָה כַּיָּדוּעַ, **— The inner meaning is well known,** דְּחַמָּה וּלְבָנָה רוֹמְזִ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינָתוֹ, **— that the sun and the moon allude to the Holy One and His Shekhinah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּסוֹטָה י.):[9] **— and as stated (in Sotah 10a):** שְׁנֶּאֱמַר: "שִׁמְשׁוֹן" – עַל שֵׁם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, **— 'Samson' (Shimshon) is named after the Holy One,** וְנֶאֱמַר: "כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן הַשֵּׁם",[10] **— as it is said: 'For a sun and a shield is Hashem';** וְכֵן הַחַמָּה גּוּף שֶׁל אֵשׁ, **— and it is said: 'For Hashem your God is a consuming fire,'** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלִהַט אֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבָּא", **— and likewise the sun is a celestial body of fire, and this is 'and the day that comes shall burn them up,'** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (נְדָרִים ח:)[11] **— and as is stated (Nedarim 8b)** דְּמוֹצִיא חַמָּה מִנַּרְתִּיקָהּ וְכוּ'.[12] **— that He extracts the sun from its sheath, etc.** (וּבִשְׁמוֹת רַבָּה שָׁם) **— (And in Shemot Rabbah there:)** דְּאוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם מוֹנִין לַחַמָּה שֶׁהִיא שֶׁל אֵשׁ וַעֲתִידִין לִידּוֹן בָּהּ, **— the nations reckon by the sun, which is of fire, and are destined to be judged by it;** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל לַלְּבָנָה שֶׁהִיא שֶׁל אוֹר, **— while Israel reckon by the moon, which is of light,** וְכֵן הֵם נוֹחֲלִין הָאוֹר, **— and thus they inherit the light,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק" וְגוֹמֵר[13] **— as it is said: 'Light is sown for the righteous, etc.',** וְאוֹמֵר: "קוּמִי אוֹרִי כִּי בָא אוֹרֵךְ", עַיֵּין שָׁם. **— and it says: 'Arise, shine, for your light has come,' see there.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּהָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת קָרוּ לֵיהּ "אֱלָהָא דְּאֱלָהָא", **— Namely, idolaters call Him 'the God of gods,'** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (סוֹף מְנָחוֹת קי.)[14, 15] **— as stated (end of Menachot 110a)** עַל פָּסוּק "גְּדוֹל שְׁמִי בַּגּוֹיִם", **— on the verse 'My Name is great among the nations,'** הַיְינוּ שֶׁאֵין מַשְׁגִּיחַ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים כְּלָל. **— meaning that they presume He exercises no providence in the lower realms at all.** אֲבָל עִיקַּר בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **— However, the prime purpose of the world's creation** לְגַלּוֹת כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ בָּעוֹלָם, **— is to manifest the honor of His kingship in the world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כֹּל פָּעַל ה' לַמַּעֲנֵהוּ",[16] **— as it is said: 'Hashem made**

---

[7] **Peri Tzadik, Yitro 7:1**: "In truth, the blessed God cannot be grasped at all, and the description 'holy' does not apply to Him except because Israel recognizes His holiness. This is what is called apprehending Him: that He is holy, separate from every apprehension. Through this, the blessed God is called holy. This is why, concerning God's holiness, he brought the verse, 'You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel': through Israel's praises, the blessed God is called holy, because they recognize His holiness and kingship."

[8] **Psalms 22:4**: 'Yet You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel.'

[9] **Sotah 10a**: 'Rabbi Yochanan said: Shimshon judged Israel like their Father in heaven, as it says, 'Dan shall judge his people as one.' Rabbi Yochanan also said: Shimshon was called by a name of the Holy One, blessed be He, for it says, 'For Hashem God is a sun and a shield.' But if so, should his name not be erasable? Rather, his name is similar to the name of the Holy One: just as the Holy One shields the entire world, so Shimshon shielded Israel in his generation."'

[10] **Psalms 84:12**: 'For Hashem God is a sun and a shield; Hashem gives grace and honor, and withholds no good from those who walk in integrity.'

[11] **Nedarim 8b:6-7**: "This differs from Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish's teaching. For he said: In the World to Come there is no Gehinnom; rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, brings the sun out of its sheath. The righteous are healed by it, and the wicked are judged by it, as it says, 'For you who fear My name, a sun shall shine,' and so forth. Moreover, the righteous take delight in it, as it says, 'You shall go out and flourish like calves of the stall.' The wicked are judged by it, as it says, 'Behold, the day is coming, burning like a furnace,' and so forth."

[12] **Nedarim 8b, citing Malachi 3:20**: 'But for you who fear My name, a sun of righteousness shall rise, with healing in its wings; and you shall go forth and leap like calves from the stall.'

[13] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

[14] **Menachot 110a; Malachi 1:11**: 'Rav Shimi bar Chiyya raised an objection to Rav: 'From the rising of the sun to its setting, My Name is great among the nations; and in every place offerings are burned and brought in My Name, and a pure meal-offering.' Rav replied: 'Are you Shimi? The nations call Him the God of gods.'"'

[15] **Menachot 110a:5**: "Rav Shimi bar Chiyya challenged Rav from the verse, 'From the rising of the sun until its setting, My name is great among the nations; in every place incense is burned and brought to My name, and a pure offering.' Rav answered him, 'Shimi, is that you? The verse means that they call Him the God of gods.'"

[16] **Proverbs 16:4**: 'Hashem has made everything for His purpose, even the wicked for the day of evil.'

everything for His sake,' וְאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שׁוֹחֵר טוֹב, תְּהִלִּים קמח):[17, 18] **— and our Sages said (Shocher Tov, Tehillim 148):** "לְקִילּוּסוֹ". **— 'for His praise,'** וְזֶהוּ שְׁכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּתַחְתּוֹנִים. **— and this is His holy Shekhinah residing in the lower realms.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן לְפַרְסֵם זֶה בָּעוֹלָם, **— And Abraham our father, peace be upon him, was the first to publicize this in the world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשַׁת חַיֵּי שָׂרָה נט, ח):[19] **— as our Sages wrote (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashat Chayei Sarah 59:8)**, עַל פָּסוּק "אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם וֵאלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ", **— on the verse 'God of the heavens and God of the earth':** וְעַכְשָׁיו "אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ" — **— and now 'God of the earth'—** שֶׁפִּרְסֵם הַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים. **— for he proclaimed His providence in the lower realms.** וְאָמַר עַל דְּאָמַר (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ל):[20] **— And it was said on this (Bereishit Rabbah, end of Parashah 30):** לֵיהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: "עַד שֶׁאַתָּה מֵאִיר לִי מֵאַסְפּוֹטַמְיָא, **— 'While you illuminate for Me from Mesopotamia,** בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלַי", **— that the Holy One said to him: come and illuminate before Me in the Land of Israel, etc.'** דָּזֶה נִקְרָא שֶׁמְּאִיר לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ,[21] **— For this is defined as illuminating before Him,** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמְּפָרְסֵם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ עַל כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה. **— by spreading the glory of His sovereignty over all Creation.** וְזֶה דּוּגְמַת הַלְּבָנָה הַמְקַבֶּלֶת אוֹר מֵהַחַמָּה, **— And this parallels the moon, which receives its luminescence from the**

---

[17] **Midrash Tehillim, Psalm 148 (Rav Tzadok's citation); compare Midrash Tehillim 19:2**: 'Rav Tzadok quotes the word "le-killuso"—"for His praise." A parallel formulation is found at Midrash Tehillim 19:2: "For His praise: because all praise Him for His work, and all His deeds praise Him."'

[18] **Midrash Tehillim 148:1**: '"Hallelujah. Praise the Lord from the heavens": those who are in the heavens. Who are they? The ministering angels. "Praise Him, all His angels." Just as there are many hosts on earth, so there are in heaven: "These are the generations of the heavens and the earth when they were created" (Genesis 2:4). Therefore it says, "Praise Him, all His hosts." Who are His hosts? Those who do the will of the Holy One, blessed be He, as it says, "Bless the Lord, all His hosts" (Psalms 103:21). Therefore it says, "Praise Him, all His hosts." "Praise Him, sun and moon." Who are the sun and moon? The patriarchs and matriarchs, who are compared to the sun and moon, as it says, "And behold, the sun and the moon" (Genesis 37:9). "Praise Him, all stars of light." Who are the stars of light? The righteous, as it says, "Those who lead the many to righteousness are like the stars" (Daniel 12:3). Therefore it says, "Praise Him, all stars of light." From here you learn that each of them has a star in heaven, and his star shines according to his deeds. Therefore it says: Praise Him, those whose stars shine. "Praise Him, heavens of heavens." From here you learn that there are only three heavens—the reading given in the name of Radal. So it says, "Behold, the heavens and the heavens of heavens" (I Kings 8:27). Therefore it says, "Praise Him." These are the waters, those waters of Creation, as it says, "God called the firmament 'heavens'" (Genesis 1:8): it bears water. "Let them praise the name of the Lord." The Holy One, blessed be He, had no toil when He created them, as it says, "On the day that the Lord God made" (Genesis 2:4), and it is written, "For in six days the Lord made" (Exodus 20:11). The Holy One, blessed be He, had no toil; He only commanded, and they came into being of themselves. Therefore it says, "Let them praise the name of the Lord," for they were created on this condition: to praise Him. "He established them forever and ever; He gave a decree that shall not pass." What decree did He give? He said to them, "Let there be a firmament" (Genesis 1:6). From that day they have not moved. The Holy One, blessed be He, created the world to rejoice in it. Yet, as it were, He had no joy in it, because Adam sinned and the ground was cursed, as it says, "Cursed is the ground" (Genesis 3:17). Cain came and killed Abel. He said to him, "Where is Abel your brother?" (Genesis 4:9), "The voice of your brother's blood cries out to Me from the ground" (Genesis 4:10), and "You shall be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth" (Genesis 4:12). He did not let the Holy One, blessed be He, rejoice in His works."

[19] **Bereishit Rabbah 59:8 — Avraham makes Hashem known on earth**: 'Avraham said to his servant, the elder of his house." On "Hashem, God of heaven," Rabbi Pinchas said: "Before I made Him known to His creatures—He was called God of heaven; but once I had made Him known to His creatures—He was called God of the earth."'

[20] **Bereishit Rabbah 30:10 — Avraham illuminates before the King**: 'Noach walked with God." Rabbi Yehudah likened this to a prince with two sons, one younger and one older: he said to the younger, "Walk with me," but to the elder, "Come, walk before me." Thus Avraham, whose strength was greater, was told "Walk before Me," while Noach walked with God. Rabbi Nechemiah compared Noach to the king's friend sinking in thick mud, whom the king summoned to walk beside him; Avraham is compared to the king's friend who shone light for him through a window in dark alleys. The king said: "Rather than illuminating Me through a window, come illuminate before Me." Thus the Holy One said to Avraham: "Instead of lighting My way from Mesopotamia and its cities, come and illuminate before Me in the Land of Israel."'

[21] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 261:1**: "The Holy One, blessed be He—His glory fills the whole earth, and no place is empty of Him. Yet He is greatly concealed: 'He makes darkness His hiding place.' When this recognition illuminates a person's heart—how the blessed God's glory fills the whole earth—this is called 'He brought us from darkness to great light,' as stated in the Haggadah. The Exodus from Egypt is the passage from the concealment of the recognition of the blessed God into its revelation. It is an illumination both for the person and for the blessed God, as our Sages said at the end of Bereishit Rabbah, chapter 30: a parable of a king walking through dark alleyways, whose friend came and lit a lamp. Abraham our father, peace be upon him, illuminated before the blessed God. For this is called the Divine Presence in exile: when His Presence among the lower beings is profoundly concealed and is neither revealed nor publicly known, it is like walking through dark alleyways."

sun; ,"קוּמִי אוֹרִי": וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **and this is 'Arise, shine,'—** שְׁיִשְׂרָאֵל מְאִירִין לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ; — **that Israel illuminate before Him;** ?וּמֵהֵיכָן לוֹקְחִין אוֹר — **and whence do they draw this light?** "אוֹרֵךְ": עַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **Via Hashem: 'your light'—He shines upon them.**[22] וְעַל דָּרֶךְ זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (תְּצַוֶּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה לו) — **And in this manner they expounded in Midrash Rabbah (Tetzaveh, end of Parashah 36) regarding the Menorah:** בַּמְּנוֹרָה: הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מֵאִיר לְכָל הָעוֹלָם — **the Holy One illuminates the whole universe,** וּמְצַוֶּה לְהָאִיר לְפָנָיו. — **yet commands that they illuminate before Him.** ,כִּי שֶׁמֶן הִיא חָכְמָה[23] — **For oil represents Chokhmah (Wisdom),** .וְאוֹר הַשֶּׁמֶן הִיא אוֹר תּוֹרָה — **and the light of the oil is the light of the Torah.**

Human differences give Oral Torah its particular expressions

,וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב[24] — **And Hashem illuminates through the light of the Written Torah,** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מְאִירִים בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and Israel illuminate through the Oral Torah,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ מַה שֶּׁהֵם מְחַדְּשִׁים. — **which is what they innovate through analysis.** ,"דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים" וּבֶאֱמֶת גַּם זֶה — **And in truth, these too are the 'words of the living God,'** ,כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּעֵירוּבִין יג:) וְכֵן אִיתָא (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב.)[25, 26] — **as stated (in Eruvin 13b) and so brought (Bava Batra 12a),** וְעַיֵּין שָׁם בָּרַמְבַּ"ן דְּהוּא בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְעָדִיף מִנְּבוּאָה. — **and see there in the Ramban that it stems from the Holy Spirit and is superior to prophecy.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מָסַר זֶה לַחֲכָמִים, — **Nevertheless, Hashem delivered this over to the Sages** כְּאִילּוּ הֵם הַמְּאִירִים זֶה, — **as if they are the ones generating this illumination;** – וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁ"בָּא אוֹרֵךְ" — **and by virtue of 'your light has come'—** מַה שֶּׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר לְלִבָּם, — **that which Hashem shines into their hearts,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה הֵם מְאִירִים לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **thereby they shine back before Him.** ,וְאָמַר "קוּמִי אוֹרִי" תְּחִלָּה — **And Scripture states 'Arise, shine' first,** דְּבְהִתְגַּלּוּת הֵם הַמְּאִירִים בְּעַצְמָם. — **for in overt manifestation they are the ones actively illuminating.** ,"וְעַל זֶה אָמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שָׁם: "לְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶיךָ תִּכְסֹף[27] — **And upon this the Midrash stated: 'You will yearn for the work of Your hands,'—** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִתְאַוֶּה לָהֶם — **that Hashem yearns for them,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְרָא עַל שֵׁם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהֵם הַמְּאִירִים. — **that it be ascribed to the children of Israel, that they are the luminaries.** וְזֶה הוּא חֲנֻכַּת אַהֲרֹן, — **And this matter is the dedication of Aaron,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ) — **as stated in the Midrash (beginning of Parashat Beha'alotekha),** כִּי הוּא הַשׁוֹרֵשׁ דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **for**

---

[22] **Isaiah 60:1-3**: 'Arise, shine, for your light has come, and the glory of Hashem has dawned upon you. For behold, darkness covers the earth and thick cloud the peoples, but upon you Hashem will dawn, and His glory will be seen upon you. Nations will walk by your light, and kings by the brightness of your rising.'

[23] **Exodus 27:20**: 'You shall command the children of Israel to bring you pure olive oil, beaten for the light, to kindle a lamp continually.'

[24] **Sichat Malakhei HaSharet 1:10**: "Therefore the greater part of Torah is oral, as stated in Gittin. What is written encompasses all Israel, and all souls are equal in it: these are the general principles. In the particulars, however, they divide according to the particulars of the souls. Just as bodily healing differs with the constitutions of bodies and with changes between generations—what benefits this body or this generation will not benefit another—so it is with the healing of the soul. From this arose all the disagreements in Oral Torah: each spoke according to the level of his soul, identifying what was appropriate to its repair and healing. Therefore 'these and those are words of the living God,' for both were given by one Shepherd. The distinctions between the judgments correspond to the distinctions between the souls."
Sichat Malakhei HaSharet explains what the human contribution can add: the common principles of Torah take particular forms suited to different souls and circumstances. This illuminates how the Sages' own analysis can be both their distinctive contribution and divine teaching. The surrounding discussion concerns the discernment of qualified Torah teachers; the comparison does not turn every private opinion into an equally authoritative ruling.

[25] **Eruvin 13b**: 'For three years Beis Shammai and Beis Hillel disagreed. These said: the halachah is according to us; and these said: the halachah is according to us. A heavenly voice went forth and declared: Both these and those are the words of the living God, but the halachah follows Beis Hillel." The Gemara continues: "Because they were patient and humble, and studied both their own words and those of Beis Shammai, even placing Beis Shammai's words before their own."'

[26] **Bava Batra 12a:13-14**: "Rabbi Avdimi of Haifa said: From the day the Temple was destroyed, prophecy was taken from the prophets and given to the Sages. Is a sage, then, not also a prophet? This is what he meant: Although prophecy was taken from the prophets, it was not taken from the Sages. Amemar said: A sage is even greater than a prophet, as it says, 'And let us bring a heart of wisdom.' Reading 'and let us bring,' ve-navi, as an allusion to a prophet, he asks: Who is being compared to whom? You must say that the lesser is compared to the greater; the prophet is thus compared to the sage."

[27] **Job 14:15**: 'You will call, and I will answer You; You will long for the work of Your hands.'

he is the root of the Oral Torah, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "יוֹרוּ מִשְׁפָּטֶיךָ לְיַעֲקֹב" וְגוֹמֵר[28] **— as it is said: 'They shall teach Your judgments to Jacob, etc.',** וְנֶאֱמַר: "וּבָאתָ אֶל הַכֹּהֲנִים" וְגוֹמֵר "עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר יוֹרוּךָ" וְגוֹמֵר **— and said: 'And you shall come unto the priests... according to the Torah they teach you, etc.',** וְנֶאֱמַר: "שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דָעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ" וְגוֹמֵר.[29] **— and said: 'The lips of the priest... and they shall seek Torah from his mouth, etc.'** וְחַמָּה וּלְבָנָה רוֹמְזִים גַּם כֵּן לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— And the sun and the moon likewise allude to the Written Torah and Oral Torah,** דְּמְקַבְּלִים הָאוֹר מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **— since they receive the illumination from the Written Torah.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א, צז עַמּוּד ב):[30, 31] **— And therefore they stated in the Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar Part I, 97b):** דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּא בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **— that the Holy One comes on Rosh Chodesh** לְמִשְׁמַע אוּלָפָן מִנִּשְׁמָתְהוֹן דְּצַדִּיקַיָּא, **— to hear teachings of Torah from the souls of the righteous,** שַׁאֲז הוּא הָאָרַת הָאוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— for then shines the illumination of the Oral Torah,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ יִכְסֹף לְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדָיו; **— and Hashem yearns for the work of His hands;** וְעַל כֵּן מָסַר קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ לַחֲכָמִים, **— and therefore He handed the sanctification of the New Moon to the Sages,** כִּי הֵם הַמְאִירִים אוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— for they are the ones who radiate the light of the Oral Torah.** וְזֶה הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשְּׁכִינָה בְּלִבּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— And this is the revelation of the Shekhinah within the hearts of Israel,** דְּזֶהוּ כָּל עִנְיַן אוֹר תּוֹרָה: **— for this is the essence of the light of Torah:** לְהָאִיר לַלֵּב בְּדַעַת אֱלֹהִים, **— to illuminate the heart with the knowledge of God,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לֶעָתִיד: "וְלֹא יְלַמְּדוּ עוֹד אִישׁ אֶת רֵעֵהוּ וְגוֹמֵר "כִּי כוּלָּם יֵדְעוּ אוֹתִי".[32] **— as is stated regarding the ultimate future: 'And they shall no more teach every man his neighbor, … for they shall all know Me, etc.'** וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אָמַר לִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, **— And King David, peace be upon him, said to King Solomon, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— who is the root of the lower wisdom of the Oral Torah,** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמַּלְכוּת, פֶּה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— the root of Malchut, the mouth of the Oral Torah,** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ: "דַּע אֶת אֱלֹהֵי" וְגוֹמֵר, **— saying to him: 'Know the God of…,' etc.,** וְנֶאֱמַר (מִשְׁלֵי ט, י): "מִפִּיו דַּעַת וּתְבוּנָה". **— and this is 'from His mouth come knowledge and understanding.'**

"וְדַעַת קְדֹשִׁים בִּינָה",[33] **— And it is said (Mishlei 9:10): 'and the knowledge of the holy ones is understanding,'** וּבִינָה הוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, שֶׁמְּבִין דָּבָר מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר, **— and Binah (Understanding) is the Oral Torah, understanding one concept from within another,** וְזֶהוּ "דַּעַת קְדֹשִׁים" – שֶׁהוּא הַדַּעַת אוֹתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, **— and this is the 'knowledge of the holy ones'—the intimate awareness of Him, blessed be He,** שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי תַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— which is attained via the Oral Torah.** וְדַעַת הוּא רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי בְּפָרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא,[34] **— And Da'at (Knowledge) is the Holy Spirit, as Rashi wrote in Parashat Ki Tisa,** וְהוּא הַשָּׂגַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל; **— and it is the profound perception of the Oral Torah as mentioned above;** וְעַל

---

[28] **Deuteronomy 33:10**: 'They shall teach Your judgments to Yaakov and Your Torah to Israel; they shall place incense before You and a whole offering upon Your altar.'

[29] **Malachi 2:7**: 'For the lips of a priest should guard knowledge, and Torah they should seek from his mouth, for he is a messenger of Hashem of Hosts.'

[30] **Zohar, Vayera 2:23-24**: "Rabbi Eliezer was sitting and studying Torah. Rabbi Akiva came to him and said, "What is the master studying?" He said to him, "This verse, which is written: 'And He causes them to inherit a throne of glory' (I Samuel 2:8). What is meant by 'He causes them to inherit a throne of glory'? This is Jacob our father, for whom He made a throne of glory of his own, to receive the teaching of the souls of the righteous. "The Holy One, blessed be He, goes with him at the beginning of each and every month. When the soul sees the glory of the mirror, the Divine Presence of its Master, it blesses and bows before the Holy One, blessed be He. This is what is written: 'Bless the Lord, O my soul' (Psalms 104:1).""

[31] **Zohar, Vayera 1:3-4**: ""the time of song was come", the earth being now ripe to offer up praises to the Almighty, which it could not do before man was created. "And the voice of the turtle is heard in our land": this is the word of God, which was not in the world till man was created. Thus when man was there, everything was there. When man sinned, the earth was cursed, and all these good things left it, as it is written, "cursed is the earth for thy sake" (Gen. 3, 17), and again, "when thou tillest the ground it shall not give its strength to thee" (Ibid. 4, 12), and again, "thorns and thistles it shall bring forth to thee" (Ibid. 3, 18)."

[32] **Jeremiah 31:33-34**: 'I shall place My Torah within them, and upon their heart I shall write it; I shall be their God, and they shall be My people. No longer shall a man teach his fellow, or a man his brother, saying, 'Know Hashem,' for they shall all know Me, from their smallest to their greatest ... for I shall forgive their wrongdoing, and their sin I shall remember no more."'

[33] **Proverbs 9:10**: 'The beginning of wisdom is fear of Hashem, and the knowledge of the Holy One is understanding.'

[34] **Rashi on Exodus 31:3**: 'Wisdom" refers to that which a person learns from others; "understanding" means apprehending one matter from another; and "knowledge" is holy inspiration (ruach hakodesh).'"

כֵּן נִקְרָא "דַּעַת קְדוֹשִׁים", — **and therefore it is called 'knowledge of the holy ones',** דִּ"קְדוֹשִׁים" הוּא שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, — **for 'holy ones' are those who possess the Holy Spirit,** דִּקְדוּשָּׁתָם מִקְּדוּשָּׁתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **their holiness emanating directly from His holiness.** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל נִבְחֲרוּ לִהְיוֹת כּוּלָּם כֵּן, — **And Israel were chosen so that all of them would be on this level,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "כִּי עַם קָדוֹשׁ אַתָּה",[35] — **and as it is written: 'For a holy people are you,'** וְנֶאֱמַר: "קֹדֶשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל לַה'", — **and it is said: 'Israel is holy unto Hashem,'** "וְהְיִיתֶם קְדֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ",[36] — **and said: 'You shall be holy,' 'and you shall be holy.'** וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ בַּגְּמָרָא בְּפֶרֶק רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וּבְפֶרֶק קַמָּא דְּחֻלִּין:[37] "קְדֹשִׁים". — **And so they are termed in the Gemara in the chapter 'Rabbi Akiva' and in the first chapter of Chullin:** "יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדוֹשִׁים". — **'Israel are holy.'** וְעַל זֶה הָיָה מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, — **And for this purpose the Giving of the Torah took place,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ לִי מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים וְגוֹי קָדוֹשׁ".[39] — **as it is said: 'And you shall be unto Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.'** וְכֹהֲנִים הֵם הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, — **And the priests are the dedicated holy ones,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּרֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת אֱמוֹר: "קְדֹשִׁים יִהְיוּ" וְגוֹמֵר, — **as is said at the beginning of Parashat Emor: 'They shall be holy, etc.',** "קָדֹשׁ יִהְיֶה לָךְ" וְגוֹמֵר "כִּי אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם מְקַדְּשׁוֹ", — **'He shall be holy unto you,' etc., 'for I, Hashem, sanctify him,'** וּבְפָרָשַׁת קֹרַח: "אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר הַשֵּׁם הוּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ". — **and in Parashat Korach: 'the one whom Hashem chooses is the holy one.'** וְהֵם אָמְרוּ: "כָּל הָעֵדָה כֻּלָּם קְדֹשִׁים וּבְתוֹכָם הַשֵּׁם", — **And Korach's assembly claimed: 'For all the congregation are holy, and Hashem is among them,'** דְּזֶהוּ הַקְּדוּשָּׁה כְּשֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹכָם, — **for this is genuine holiness—when Hashem dwells among them,** וְהָאֱמֶת כֵּן. — **and in ultimate truth it is so.** וְלֶעָתִיד יִהְיֶה לְגַמְרֵי כֵּן, — **And in the ultimate future it will be fully realized,** וְיִהְיֶה מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים, — **and all will be a kingdom of priests,** וְ"שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת", — **and 'the priest's lips shall keep knowledge,'** וְאָז "כּוּלָּם יֵדְעוּ" וְגוֹמֵר. — **and then 'all of them shall know Me, etc.'**

Shared holiness includes distinct roles in receiving and transmitting it

וּבְמַעֲמַד הַר סִינַי הָיוּ כּוּלָּם כֵּן,[40] — **And at the Revelation at Mount Sinai all of them were on this level,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה עַל פָּסוּק "יִשָּׁקֵנִי"; — **as stated in Shir HaShirim Rabbah on the verse 'Let him kiss me';** אֲבָל אַחַר כָּךְ, אַף דְּיֵשׁ קְדוּשָּׁה בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל, מִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ מַדְרֵיגוֹת, — **yet afterward, even though holiness permeates all Israel, nevertheless gradations exist,** וְהָיוּ צְרִיכִין לְקַבֵּל מִמֹּשֶׁה וּמַאֲהָרֹן, — **and they needed to**

---

[35] **Deuteronomy 14:2**: ‘For you are a holy people to Hashem your God; and Hashem has chosen you to be His treasured people among all the nations upon the face of the earth.’

[36] **Jeremiah 2:3**: ‘Israel was holy to Hashem, the first of His harvest; all who consumed him would become guilty; disaster would come upon them—declares Hashem.’

[37] **Leviticus 19:2**; **Leviticus 20:7**: “‘Speak to the whole congregation of the children of Israel and say to them: You shall be holy, for I, Hashem your God, am holy.’ ‘Sanctify yourselves and be holy, for I am Hashem your God.’”

[38] **Shabbat 86a and Chullin 7b — “Israel are holy”**: ‘Shabbat 86a: “Why was it necessary for him to tell them? Did Rav Huna not say: Israel are holy and do not engage in marital relations by day? ... Rava said: If the house is dark, it is permitted.” Chullin 7b: “Do you imagine I am prohibited from receiving benefit from Israel? Israel are holy: one wishes to give but lacks the means, while another has the means but does not wish to give; yet he says, ‘Eat and drink,’ though his heart is not with you.”’

[39] **Exodus 19:6**: ‘You shall be to Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation. These are the words you shall speak to the children of Israel.’

[40] **Yisrael Kedoshim 5:4**: “For Aaron, peace be upon him, was the one set apart from Israel, ‘to sanctify him as most holy.’ In him appeared the strongest revelation of the utmost holiness and separation that can be revealed in this world. Therefore he entered the Holy of Holies, the place of which it says, ‘No person shall be in the Tent of Meeting when he comes to make atonement in the holy place.’ Our Sages explained in the Jerusalem Talmud: even those whose faces have the likeness of a human face the angels. There is a holiness above that of the angels which they cannot reach; only the righteous can, whose place is further within than that of the ministering angels. Israel are ‘one nation,’ all together one complete stature. Yet, just as the human body has principal organs in which life is stronger, such as the heart, the source of life, so the other organs have different levels.”
Yisrael Kedoshim gives Rav Tzadok’s distinction an organic form: Israel constitute one living whole, while its members have different capacities to receive and transmit holiness. Aaron’s special role belongs within that shared life. This helps explain why the holiness of the entire people is compatible with the need for Aaron to establish Torah in their hearts.

receive the transmission from Moses and Aaron, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּעֵירוּבִין נד:)[41, 42] **— as stated (in Eruvin 54b):** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר (בְּשָׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה טו)[43] **— And on this it is said (in Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 15):** – "'שְׁלַח אוֹרְךָ וַאֲמִתְּךָ' וְגוֹמֵר" **— 'Send Your light and Your truth, etc.'—** הֵם מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן, **— these are Moses and Aaron,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: 'תֻּמֶּיךָ וְאוּרֶיךָ' וְגוֹמֵר, **— as it is written: 'Your Thummim and Your Urim, etc.',** וְנֶאֱמַר: 'תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת הָיְתָה בְּפִיהוּ'[44] **— and said: 'The law of truth was in his mouth, etc.';** וְכוּלֵי, עַיֵּין שָׁם. וְאָמַר: 'הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם' – זֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר" **— and it says: 'This month shall be unto you'—this is what Scripture states, etc., see there.** וּרְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר דְּזֶהוּ עִנְיַן קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ שֶׁנִּמְסַר לָהֶם, **— And this means that this is the essence of the New Moon's sanctification delivered to them,** דְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה מְאִירִים לִלְבּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— that through it they radiate into the hearts of the children of Israel.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה, **— And Moses our teacher, peace be upon him, is the root of the light of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַתֵּרֶא אֹתוֹ כִּי טוֹב", **— as it is said: 'And she saw him that he was good,'** (סוֹטָה יב.);[45, 46] שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד נִתְמַלֵּא הַבַּיִת אוֹרָה **— for when he was born the entire house was filled with light (Sotah 12a);** וְשֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְבָּע בַּלֵּב הוּא עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן, **— and that it become permanently ingrained in the heart via Aaron,** שׁוּשְׁבִינָא דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא, **— the attendant of the Matronita (Shekhinah),** שֶׁמְּקָרְבָן לַתּוֹרָה, **— who draws souls near to the Torah;** וְזֶהוּ "תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת הָיְתָה בְּפִיהוּ", **— and this is 'the Torah of truth that was in his mouth,'** וּשְׂפַת אֱמֶת הוּא שֶׁתִּכּוֹן לָעַד: **— and a truthful lip is one that endures forever.** עַד כָּאן מִכְּתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ. **— Until here from his holy handwriting.**

---

[41] **Eruvin 54b**: ‘What was the order of teaching the Mishnah? Moshe learned from the Almighty. Aharon entered, and Moshe taught him his portion; Aharon moved aside and sat at Moshe’s left. His sons entered, and Moshe taught them their portion; the sons then moved aside. The elders entered and Moshe taught them; afterward the whole people entered and Moshe taught them.’

[42] **Eruvin 54b:11-12**: “The Sages taught: What was the order in which the teaching was repeated? Moshe learned from the mouth of the Almighty. Aharon entered, and Moshe taught him his lesson. Aharon withdrew and sat to Moshe’s left. Aharon’s sons entered, and Moshe taught them their lesson. His sons withdrew; Elazar sat to Moshe’s right, and Itamar to Aharon’s left. Rabbi Yehudah says: Aharon always returned to Moshe’s right. The elders entered, and Moshe taught them their lesson. The elders withdrew; all the people entered, and Moshe taught them their lesson. Aharon thus had heard it four times, his sons three times, the elders twice, and all the people once. Moshe withdrew, and Aharon repeated his lesson to them. Aharon withdrew, and his sons repeated their lesson to them. His sons withdrew, and the elders repeated their lesson to them. Everyone thus had heard the teaching four times.”

[43] **Shemot Rabbah 15:14** (excerpt): “Another interpretation of ‘This month shall be for you’: It is written, ‘I sent before you Moshe, Aharon, and Miriam’ (Micah 6:4). This is what Scripture says: ‘Send Your light and Your truth; they shall guide me’ (Psalms 43:3). These are Moshe and Aharon, as it says, ‘Of Levi he said: Your Thummim and Your Urim’ (Deuteronomy 33:8), and likewise, ‘A Torah of truth was in his mouth’ (Malachi 2:6).”

[44] **Malachi 2:6 — Torah of truth in the priest’s mouth**: ‘A Torah of truth was in his mouth and no wrongdoing was found upon his lips; in peace and uprightness he walked with Me, and he turned many back from sin.’

[45] **Sotah 12a and Exodus 2:2**: ‘The woman conceived and bore a son, and she saw that he was good, and she hid him for three months.” The Sages expound “she saw that he was good” as referring to light filling the house at Moshe’s birth.’

[46] **Sotah 12a:17**: “‘She saw that he was good.’ It was taught: Rabbi Meir says: His name was Tov, ‘Good.’ Rabbi Yehudah says: His name was Toviyyah. Rabbi Nechemyah says: He was fit for prophecy. Others say: He was born circumcised. The Sages say: When Moshe was born, the entire house filled with light. Here it is written, ‘She saw that he was good,’ and there it is written, ‘God saw that the light was good.’”

Rosh Chodesh Mar Cheshvan

Marcheshvan: Awe, Judgment, Rain, and Rectification

The Temple makes the Divine Presence an enduring dwelling and thereby brings awe into the world. Rav Tzadok distinguishes this awareness of standing before God from fear of punishment.

Marcheshvan: Awe, Judgment, Rain, and Rectification

אִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: — **It is stated in Sefer Yetzirah:** "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נוּ"ן בְּרֵיחַ וְכוּלֵי וְחֶשְׁוָן בַּשָּׁנָה".[47] — **"He made the letter Nun rule over smell, etc., and Cheshvan in the year."** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, צא עַמּוּד א):[48] — **In the holy Zohar (Part II, 91a):** "נו"ן – רָזָא לְמִדְחַל מְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, — **'The letter Nun is the mystery of revering the Holy One,** וּלְמִנְדַּע דְּאִית דִּין וְאִית דַּיָּין,[49] — **and knowing that there is judgment and there is a Judge,** וְאִית אֲגַר טָב לְצַדִּיקַיָּא וּפֻרְעָנוּתָא לְרִשִׁיעַיָּא, — **and there is good reward for the righteous and retribution for the wicked,** בְּגִין דְּרָזָא דִּילֵיהּ הֵ"א תַּתָּאָה"; — **because its esoteric mystery is the lower Hei';** וְיָדוּעַ דְּהֵ"א תַּתָּאָה הוּא וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (אַחֲרֵי מוֹת סוֹ עַמּוּד ב):[50, 51] — **and it is known that the lower Hei represents Malchut, and so it is in the holy Zohar (Acharei Mot 66b):** "נו"ן כְּפוּפָה – דָּא מַטְרוֹנִיתָא", עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **'A bent Nun—this is the Matronita (Shekhinah/Malchut),' see there.** "וּמֶלֶךְ בְּמִשְׁפָּט יַעֲמִיד אָרֶץ",[52] — **And 'a king by justice establishes the land,'** וְהוּא שֵׁם אֲדנ-ות, דִּינָא דְּמַלְכוּתָא. — **which corresponds to the Divine Name Adonai, the royal law of judgment.** וּבְמַאֲמַר פְּתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ: "צֶדֶק יְדִיעָא דְּאִיהוּ דִּין", — **And in the discourse Petach Eliyahu: 'Tzedek is known as Din (Judgment)',** וְזֶהוּ "דְּאִית דִּין"; — **and this is 'there is judgment';** וְכֵן בָּעֵי דְּבָמֶלֶךְ נֶאֱמַר: "שׂוֹם" וְגוֹמֵר – לְמִדְחַל, — **for concerning a king it is said: 'You shall set a king over you...'—** וְנֶאֱמַר:[53] "וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אֲנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי". שֶׁתְּהֵא אֵימָתוֹ עָלֶיךָ, — **that his dread be upon you;** — **and it is said: 'And if I be a Master, where is My fear?'** וּבְחֶשְׁוָן הִתְחִיל מִשְׁפַּט דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל — **And in Cheshvan the judgment of the generation of the Flood began,** אֲשֶׁר הִרְבּוּ לַחֲטֹא וְלֹא יָרְאוּ אֱלֹהִים, — **who sinned abundantly and did not fear God,** וְאָמְרוּ דְּלֵית דִּין וְלֵית דַּיָּין, — **proclaiming that there is neither judgment nor Judge,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וַיֹּאמְרוּ לָאֵל סוּר מִמֶּנּוּ" וְגוֹמֵר — **as is written: 'They said to God, "Depart from us,"' etc.,** "כִּי נַעֲבָדֶנּוּ וּמַה נּוֹעִיל כִּי נִפְגַּע בּוֹ".[54] — **'that we should serve Him? And what would we gain by entreating Him?'** וְעַד גְּמַר בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת עַל יְדֵי שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **And until the completion of the Temple's construction by King Solomon, peace be upon him,** הָיָה רֹאשׁ מִשְׁפַּט דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל בָּעוֹלָם, — **the**

---

[47] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:9**: 'He made the letter lamed king over intercourse, bound a crown to it, joined them together, and formed with them Libra in the world, Tishrei in the year, and the gallbladder in the person, male and female. He made the letter nun king over scent, bound a crown to it, joined them together, and formed with them Scorpio in the world, Cheshvan in the year, and the intestines in the person, male and female. He made the letter samekh king over sleep, bound a crown to it, joined them together, and formed with them Sagittarius in the world, Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the person, male and female.'

[48] **Zohar, Yitro 30:505-517**: 'In the Zohar (Yitro II 91a), the letter Nun inside the word Anokhi is expounded: 'The letter Nun is the mystery of revering the Holy One, blessed be He, and knowing that there is judgment and there is a Judge, and that there is good reward for the righteous and retribution for the wicked—because its esoteric mystery is the lower Hei (Malkhut).'''

[49] **Zohar II 91a**: 'I am Anochi": at that moment the sanctuary was purified; the alien power did not draw near, and the sanctuary shone by itself, because the evil inclination was then nullified from the world. The Holy One, blessed be He, was exalted in His glory alone. Thus it was said, "I am Hashem your God." This is a complete mystery contained in the holy Name. Aleph: to unite the mystery of the holy Name in its levels, to make it one, for its mystery is vav. Nun: the mystery of fearing the Holy One, blessed be He, and knowing that there is judgment and a Judge; that there is a good reward for the righteous and punishment for the wicked; for the mystery of this letter is the lower hei."'

[50] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 30:186**: "It was taught: There are two letters of this kind. Just as we said of vav, spelled vav–alef –vav, so too nun, spelled nun–vav–nun. Although the matter has already been explained, nun is interpreted as follows: the bent nun is the Matronita. Beside her is vav, which is Yesod, so that she may receive blessing from it. The extended nun is the extension of Tiferet. Therefore the letters are included in one another and joined to one another. If you ask why the vav turns its face away from the bent nun and turns its face toward the extended nun: it is for the King's honor that it turns its face toward the King."

[51] **Zohar, Acharei Mot**: 'In the Zohar (Acharei Mot 66b), the bent letter Nun is identified as the mystery of the Matronita (the Shekhinah / Malkhut), which receives the supernal flow in humility and establishes royal judgment upon the earth.'

[52] **Proverbs 29:4**: 'A king establishes the land through justice, but a person of exactions destroys it.'

[53] **Malachi 1:6**: 'A son honors a father and a servant his master. If I am a Father, where is My honor? And if I am a Master, where is My fear?—says Hashem of Hosts to you, the priests who despise My name. But you say: In what have we despised Your name?'

[54] **Job 21:14-15**: 'They said to God: Depart from us; we have no desire for knowledge of Your ways. What is the Almighty, that we should serve Him? And what profit have we if we appeal to Him?'

imprint of the judgment of the Flood remained present in the world, (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ח) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב[55, 56] — **as written (Tanchuma, Noach 8)** שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה בְּחֹדֶשׁ חֶשְׁוָן הָיוּ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם הַמַּיִם שׁוֹטְפִים; — **that every year in the month of Cheshvan torrential waters poured down for forty days;** וּלְכָךְ נִקְרָא חֹדֶשׁ חֶשְׁוָן בְּמֹלְכִים (מְלָכִים א ו, לח)[57] בִּגְמַר בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת — **and for this reason the month of Cheshvan is named in Kings (I Kings 6:38) at the completion of the Temple** בְּלֹא מ״ם, "יֶרַח בּוּל" — **the 'month of Bul,' without the mem of mabul (flood),** שֶׁבִּגְמַר בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת פָּסְקוּ הָאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם רִשָּׁם מִשְׁפַּט הַמַּבּוּל. — **for upon the completion of the Temple, the forty days marking the Flood ceased.** שֶׁתַּכְלִית הַמְּכֻוָּן מֵהַבְּרִיאָה — **For the ultimate intent of Creation** לִהְיוֹת דִּירָה בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים, לִשְׁכּוֹן הַשְׁכִינָה בָּאָרֶץ; — **is to be an abode in the lower realms, for the Shekhinah to dwell upon earth;** וּבְחַטָּא דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל וְדוֹר הַפַּלָּגָה נִסְתַּלְּקָה הַשְׁכִינָה, — **and through the sin of the Flood generation and the Dispersion, the Shekhinah departed,** וְעַל יְדֵי בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת חָזְרָה. — **and through the construction of the Temple, She returned.**

A fuller revelation calls for awe that restrains spiritual self-importance

בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה הַשְׁרָאַת הַשְׁכִינָה בִּקְבִיעוּת,[58] — **In the Holy Temple, the indwelling of the Shekhinah was permanent,** וְהַיְינוּ "בַּיִת", כְּמוֹ שֶׁקָּרָא יַעֲקֹב לִמְקוֹם הַמִּקְדָּשׁ — **as Jacob named the site of the Temple a 'house',** קְבִיעוּת מָקוֹם לְגִילּוּי שְׁכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ; — **signifying an established domicile for the manifestation of His Shekhinah;** וּמִשָּׁם יִרְאָה יוֹצֵאת לָעוֹלָם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לְמַעַן תִּלְמַד — **and from there awe goes forth to the world,** לְיִרְאָה אֶת ה' אֱלֹקֶיךָ כָּל הַיָּמִים", וְגוֹמֵר, — לֹא יִרְאַת עֹנֶשׁ רַק יִרְאָה אֲמִתִּית, כִּי בְּמָקוֹם גִּילּוּי שְׁכִינָתוֹ נוֹפֵל יִרְאָה, — **as is said: 'that you may learn to fear Hashem, etc.', not merely fear of punishment, but genuine awe, for wherever His Shekhinah is unveiled, awe descends,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבְמוֹרָא גָּדוֹל – זֶה גִּלּוּי שְׁכִינָה". — **as stated: 'And with great awe—this refers to the revelation of the Shekhinah.'** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּהֲגָהָה בְּרֵישׁ אֹרַח חַיִּים: — **And as stated in the gloss of the Rema at the beginning of Orach Chayim:** כְּשֶׁשָּׂם הָאָדָם אֶל לִבּוֹ — **when a person takes to heart** שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו, — **that the King of kings, the Holy One, stands over him and sees his actions,** מִיָּד יַגִּיעַ אֵלָיו הַיִּרְאָה וְהַהַכְנָעָה מִפַּחַד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וְכוּלֵי. — **awe and subjugation from the dread of Hashem instantly fall upon him, etc.** וְאוֹת נו״ן הוּא לְשׁוֹן נְפִילָה, — **And the letter Nun denotes falling,** (בְּרָכוֹת ד:) כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר[59] — **as is stated (Berakhot 4b):** דְּלֹא נֶאֱמְרָה נו״ן בְּאַשְׁרֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ מַפַּלְתָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְכוּלֵי, — **that the letter Nun was omitted in Ashrei because in it lies the downfall of Israel, etc.,** בְּמַעֲרָבָא וְכוּלֵי: "נָפְלָה לֹא תוֹסִיף וְכוּלֵי", — **in the West (the Land of Israel) they interpreted it: 'She has fallen;**

---

55 **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11**: 'You find that from that time until Shlomo built the Holy Temple, for forty days in every year rain fell in correspondence with the waters of the Flood, which lasted forty days. When Shlomo built the Holy Temple, he sought mercy on their behalf, and these rains ceased from the world; as it is said, 'In the eleventh year, in the month of Bul.' Why is it called 'the month of Bul'? Because they brought the animals inside out of the fields."'

56 **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 8:1**: "And God spoke to Noah, saying: "Go forth from the ark" (Gen. 8:15). May our master instruct us whether one is permitted to place saliva upon an ailing eye on the Sabbath. R. Hiyya the son of Abba stated in the name of R. Levi: It is forbidden to place saliva on an ailing eye on the Sabbath, for that would be equivalent to healing on the Sabbath. Come and see that there is no ailment in all the world for which there is no cure. What is the cure for an act resulting from the evil inclination? Repentance."

57 **I Kings 6:38**: 'In the eleventh year, in the month Bul—that is the eighth month—the House was completed in all its details and according to all its ordinances; he built it over seven years.'

58 **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 8:1**: "The blessed God began building the fullness of the honor of heavenly kingship in the days of Abraham our father. With him God began to show that the honor of His kingship, as it were, reaches its complete fullness only through Israel's service. In his days it began, as it is written, 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of the Lord.' The holy Zohar explains that this is why Jacob said, 'How awesome is this place': where fullness is found, awe is found. When God began to illuminate His will that without Israel's service there would be no fullness in heavenly kingship, as it were, it followed that all this fullness was placed in Israel's hands. Israel then needed to restrain themselves with great awe. Otherwise, God forbid, they could receive an excessive sense of power from this illumination, imagining that His governance was in their hands. God would then rise above this garment and show that nothing is in the person's hands. Therefore, where fullness is found, awe is found."
Sod Yesharim explains why a greater revelation produces a greater need for awe. Being entrusted with service that contributes to heavenly honor can itself invite self-importance; awe keeps the recipient aware of the Giver. This develops Rav Tzadok's distinction between fear of punishment and the humility that accompanies awareness of the Divine Presence.

59 **Berakhot 4b**: 'Rabbi Yochanan said: Why was the letter nun not stated in Ashrei? Because it contains the downfall of the enemies of Israel, as it is written, 'Fallen, she shall not rise again, virgin Israel.' In the West they explained the verse: 'She has fallen and shall not fall again; arise, virgin Israel.' Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: Even so, David came back and upheld them with divine inspiration, as it says, 'Hashem supports all who fall.'"'

she shall not again fall,' etc.;

Torah can give a fallen person the first strength to rise

וְאָמַר שָׁם: וְאַף עַל פִּי כֵן סָמָכָן דָּוִד בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ,[60] **— and it states there: nonetheless David supported them via the Holy Spirit,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "סוֹמֵךְ ה' לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים"; **— as it is said: 'Hashem supports all who fall';** וּכְתִיב: "סֻכַּת דָּוִיד הַנֹּפֶלֶת", **— and it is written: 'the fallen tabernacle of David',** כִּי סֻכָּה דִּירַת עֲרַאי, **— for a sukkah is a temporary dwelling,** וְהַיְינוּ אַף בְּעֵת שֶׁנִּרְאֵית כְּנוֹפֶלֶת הוּא סָמְכָהּ, **— meaning that even when it seems fallen He supports it,** שֶׁמַּמְשִׁיךְ מִדַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ בָּעוֹלָם תָּמִיד. **— continually drawing down His royal presence into the world.** וְהַנְּפִילָה הוּא צוֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה, **— And the fall is for the sake of ascent,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי שֶׁבַע יִפּוֹל צַדִּיק וְלָעָתִיד כְּתִיב: "אָקִים אֶת סֻכַּת דָּוִיד הַנֹּפֶלֶת". **— as is stated: 'For seven times a righteous man falls and rises up,' and for the future it is written: 'I will raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen.'** וְאִיתָא בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יז:[61, 62] **— And it is brought (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 17):** תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה – שֵׁינָה, **— the beginning of downfall is sleep;** דָּמַיְךְ לֵיהּ וְלָא לָעֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא, **— one sleeps and does not labor in the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: כִּי עַל יְדֵי שֵׁינָה מִתְרַחֵק מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— for through sleep one is distanced from Hashem,** שֶׁמִּתְעַצֵּל מֵעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— as it is said: 'Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep,'** "עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה", **— slacking off from the service of Hashem.**

Rest can prepare renewed Torah when Torah remains within the heart

וְאִיתָא גַּם כֵּן בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט):[63, 64, 65] **— And it is brought likewise in the Midrash (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 9):** "'וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד' – טוֹבָה שֵׁינָה, **— 'And behold, it was very good'—sleep is good;** וְכִי שֵׁינָה טוֹב מְאֹד וְכוּלַּי? **— is sleep really 'very good'?** אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁהוּא יָשָׁן קִימְעָא **— Rather, because he sleeps a**

---

[60] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 236:1**: "The principal support of those who fall from their level comes through words of Torah, which give strength and sound counsel. This comes through truthful speech recognizing the greatness of the blessed God, even when the person is utterly distant from Him. Such is Torah: one is not standing before the King, so this is possible even during the fall and distance, and through it one is supported. Prayer, however, is like standing before the King, being close to Him; this is not possible at the time of the fall, since the person is not close. Even the prayer of the poor person from a broken heart is then impossible, for that too requires strength, and at the time of the fall the person lacks even this: the heart is completely blocked, like a stone. Concerning this they said, 'Draw him to the study house; if he is stone … he shatters.' Through words of Torah the person is supported and strengthened to awaken and rise from the fall."

Tzidkat HaTzadik describes how the first support can reach someone who cannot yet produce a feeling of closeness or even a brokenhearted appeal. Truthful Torah speech can precede that emotional renewal and restore the capacity to rise. This gives a concrete path to the support and renewed beginning urged in Mar Cheshvan. The contrast describes spiritual capacity in this condition; it is not a ruling that such a person should stop praying.

[61] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5 — sleep as a loss of Torah labour**: 'The Lord God caused a deep sleep to fall upon the man.' Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin in the name of Rabbi Levi said: 'Sleep is the beginning of decline: he sleeps and does not toil in Torah, and does not attend to his work.' Rav said: 'There are three kinds of deep sleep: the sleep of ordinary slumber, the sleep of prophecy, and the sleep of collapse.' The Rabbis added a sleep of folly; and Rabbi Chanina bar Yitzchak taught that sleep is a lesser reflection of death, a dream of prophecy, and Shabbos of the World to Come."'

[62] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): "'Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall' (Genesis 2:21). Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: The beginning of downfall is sleep: a person sleeps and does not labor in Torah, and does not attend to his work."

[63] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6 — "very good" and purposeful rest**: 'Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: 'And behold, it was very good'—behold, sleep is good. Is sleep really very good? Have we not learned that wine and sleep are good for the wicked and good for the world? Rather, when a person sleeps a little, he rises and toils greatly in Torah."'

[64] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6** (excerpt): "Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: 'Behold, it was very good'—behold, sleep is good. Is sleep really very good? Have we not learned that wine and sleep are beneficial for the wicked and beneficial for the world? Rather, because a person sleeps a little, he rises and labors greatly in Torah."

[65] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 204:1**: "Although everyone has a time of diminished consciousness, and it is impossible to remain always in expanded consciousness and the proper cleaving to God—as sleep was created and Bereshit Rabbah calls it 'very good,' because through it one rests and returns to receive fresh vitality—so too one must sometimes rest a little from words of Torah, and 'the suspension of Torah is its foundation.' Nevertheless, even at such a time, a person's thoughts differ according to his level in the Torah that is upon his heart. Thus with our father Jacob: his dream, the images he experienced at the time of diminished consciousness, was also 'Behold, the Lord stood over him.' So it is with each person according to his level."

Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies a criterion for the distinction between restorative rest and abandonment. The Torah already rooted in a person continues to shape even the interval of diminished attention. This explains how the interruption itself can serve renewed life in Torah, while preserving Rav Tzadok's requirement that it actually lead to renewed effort.

וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּתְתַּקֵּן הַנְּפִילָה עַצְמָהּ — **little,** הוּא עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה". — **he rises and labors in the Torah abundantly."** — **Namely, that he rectifies the fall itself** שֶׁתִּהְיֶה לוֹ סַיְיעְתָּא לַעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **so that it becomes an aid to the service of Hashem,** וּמִמֶּנָּה יִקַּח לַעֲבוֹד אֶת הַשֵּׁם. — **and from it he draws strength to serve Him.** וְכֵן אַחַר כָּךְ בְּחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו: — **And so afterward in the month of Kislev:** "הֶמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה וְכִסְלָו בַּשָּׁנָה". — **'He made the letter Samekh rule over sleep, and Kislev in the year.'** וְאָמַר "הֶמְלִיךְ אוֹת נוּ"ן בְּרֵיחַ", — **And it said, 'He made the letter Nun rule over smell,'** כִּי מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם יֵשׁ לוֹ חוּשׁ הָרֵיחַ, — **for one who possesses the fear of Hashem has the sense of smell,** עַל דָּרָךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם". — **in the manner of the verse: 'And he shall discern through the fear of Hashem,'** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מוֹרֵחַ וְדַאִין. — **that he will smell and judge.** וְהִנֵּה לְכָל חֹדֶשׁ יֵשׁ עִנְיָן מְיוּחָד לַעֲסוֹק, — **Now, every month has a unique matter to engage in,** וְחֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן הָעֵסֶק לְהִתְחַזֵּק — **and in the month of Marcheshvan the spiritual work is to strengthen oneself** לְהָחֵל לָקוּם מֵהַנְּפִילָה — **to begin rising from the fall,** וּלְהַכְנִיס עַצְמוֹ לִקְדוּשָׁה בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם: — **and to bring oneself into sanctity through the fear of Hashem.**

אִיתָא מַהָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ רַבִּי מְנַחֵם מֶענְדֶל מֵרִימַנוֹב זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, — **It is brought from the holy master Rabbi Menachem Mendel of Rimanov of blessed memory,** שֶׁבְּחֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן הֵם רוֹב גְּזֵירוֹת, — **that in the month of Marcheshvan the majority of harsh decrees occur,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז נִתְחַלְּקָה מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד. — **because then the kingdom of the House of David was divided.** וּמִן הַסְּתָם אֵינוֹ רַק לְעָנְשׁ, — **And presumably this is not merely for punishment,** רַק שֶׁבּוֹ הַזְּמַן מְסֻגָּל לְתַקֵּן זֶה. — **rather it is a uniquely propitious time to rectify this.** וְהָעִנְיָן, דְּאִיתָא בִּגְמָרָא (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא:):[66] — **And the matter is, as taught in the Gemara (Rosh Hashanah 11b):** לְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ, בְּשִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר בְּאִיָּיר הָיָה הַמַּבּוּל; — **according to Rabbi Yehoshua, on the seventeenth of Iyar the Flood began;** וּלְרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר, דִּבְתִשְׁרֵי נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם, — **and according to Rabbi Eliezer, that in Tishrei the world was created,** אוֹתוֹ הַיּוֹם שִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר בְּמַרְחֶשְׁוָן הָיָה. — **that day was the seventeenth of Marcheshvan.** וְאִיתָא: תָּנוּ רַבָּנָן, — **And it is taught: Our Rabbis taught,** חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מוֹנִין לַמַּבּוּל כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר,[67] — **the Sages of Israel reckon for the Flood according to Rabbi Eliezer,** וְלַתְּקוּפָה כְּרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ; — **and for astronomical cycles according to Rabbi Yehoshua;** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי וְתוֹסָפוֹת:[68] — **and Rashi and Tosafot explained:** לְשָׁנוֹת הָעוֹלָם מוֹנִין מִתִּשְׁרֵי כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר. — "לַמַּבּוּל" — **'for the Flood'—for the calendar years of the world we count from Tishrei like Rabbi Eliezer.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לְפִי זֶה לְשׁוֹן "לַמַּבּוּל", — **And one must understand according to this the expression 'for the Flood',** וְהָיָה לוֹ לוֹמַר: "לַשָּׁנִים" אוֹ "לִשְׁנוֹת עוֹלָם", — **for it should have said 'for years' or 'for the years of the world',** וְלָמָּה תָּפַס לְשׁוֹן "לַמַּבּוּל" שֶׁכְּבָר עָבַר? — **and why adopt the phrase 'for the Flood', which has long passed?** אֲבָל נִרְאֶה שֶׁנִּרְמַז בָּזֶה, — **However, it seems that there is an allusion in this,** דְּאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ח):[69, 70] — **for it is taught (Tanchuma, Noach 8):** אַתָּה מוֹצֵא מִן אוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה — **you find that from that time** עַד שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **until Solomon built the Holy**

---

66 **Rosh Hashanah 11b**: 'Rabbi Eliezer says: the world was created in Tishrei; Rabbi Yehoshua says: the world was created in Nisan.'

67 **Rosh Hashanah 11b**: 'Our Rabbis taught: In the six-hundredth year of Noach's life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month: Rabbi Yehoshua says that day was the seventeenth of Iyar, when the constellation Kimah sets by day and the springs diminish. Because they altered their deeds, the Holy One altered the natural order and caused Kimah to rise by day, removing two stars from Kimah and bringing the Flood upon the world. Rabbi Eliezer says: That day was the seventeenth of Marcheshvan, when Kimah rises by day and the springs grow stronger.'

68 **Rashi and Tosafot on Rosh Hashanah 11b — distinct comments**: 'Rashi (on "And these follow their respective views"): "For Rabbi Eliezer, the world was created in Tishrei, for the counting of the generations begins from Tishrei; accordingly the Flood must have begun in Marcheshvan and lasted twelve months. For Rabbi Yehoshua, who says the world was created in Nisan and counts the generations from then, the Flood began in Iyar." Tosafot (on "The day on which Kimah sets by day"): "The reading in Rabbi Eliezer's teaching is that on the seventeenth of Marcheshvan the constellation Kimah sets by day ... while concerning the seventeenth of Iyar it says that Kimah rises by day; the version in Rashi's commentary reverses this, but the zodiacal order does not support it."'

69 **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11**: 'You find that from that time until Shlomo built the Holy Temple, forty days of rain fell each and every year because of the waters of the Flood, which had been forty days. When Shlomo built the Temple, he pleaded for mercy for them and they ceased from the world, as Scripture says: 'In the eleventh year, in the month of Bul.'" The Midrash continues to explain the name of the month as the season when animals are gathered indoors.'

70 **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 8:1**: "And God spoke to Noah, saying: "Go forth from the ark" (Gen. 8:15). May our master instruct us whether one is permitted to place saliva upon an ailing eye on the Sabbath. R. Hiyya the son of Abba stated in the name of R. Levi: It is forbidden to place saliva on an ailing eye on the Sabbath, for that would be equivalent to healing on the Sabbath. Come and see that there is no ailment in all the world for which there is no cure. What is the cure for an act resulting from the evil inclination? Repentance."

Temple, אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם הָיוּ עוֹשִׂין גְּשָׁמִים בְּכָל שָׁנָה לְשׁוֹן הַמַּבּוּל, **— forty days of rains fell each year in the manner of the Flood,** וּכְשֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בִּקֵּשׁ רַחֲמִים עֲלֵיהֶם **— and when Solomon built the Temple he prayed for mercy upon them** וּפָסְקוּ מִן הָעוֹלָם וְכוּלֵי, **— and they ceased from the world, etc.,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּיֶרַח בּוּל" וְכוּלֵי. **— as it is said: 'in the month of Bul, etc.'** וְהַיְינוּ דְּדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל הָיוּ רְאוּיִם לְקַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה, **— Namely, the generation of the Flood were originally fit to receive the Torah,** אֲזַ הָיָה נִשְׁמַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, **— for the soul of Moses our teacher was present then,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּרַמְּז בַּגְּמָרָא (חֻלִּין קלט:)[71, 72] **— as the Gemara alludes (Chullin 139b):** מֹשֶׁה מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן? **— 'Where is Moses indicated in the Torah?** בְּשַׁגַּם' – בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא וּכְתִיב: 'וְהִיא יָמָיו מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה'", **— 'Inasmuch as he is also' (be-shagam = 345) equals Moses,** מֹשֶׁה', **and it is written: 'and his days shall be a hundred and twenty years.'** וְכֵן כָּתוּב מְפוֹרָשׁ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג, רטז עַמּוּד א):[73] **— And so it is explicitly written in the holy Zohar (Part III, 216a):** דַּעֲתִיד הֲוָה מֹשֶׁה לְקַבָּלָא אוֹרַיְיתָא בְּדָרָא דְּטוֹפָנָא וְכוּלֵי;[74] **— that Moses was destined to receive the Torah in the generation of the Flood, etc.;** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ל):[75] **— and so is written in the Midrash (Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 30):** "'וְדַעַת דְּרָכֶיךָ לֹא חָפָצְנוּ' – **— 'And the knowledge of Your ways we do not desire'—** שֶׁלֹּא רָצוּ לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה **— that they did not want to receive the Torah,** שֶׁהֵם דְּרָכָיו שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא". **— which are the ways of the Holy One."** וּכְתִיב: "בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה נִבְקְעוּ כָּל מַעְיְנוֹת תְּהוֹם רַבָּה" וְגוֹמֵר, **— And it is written: 'On that day all the fountains of the great deep burst open, etc.',** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א, קיז עַמּוּד א) רָמְזוּ בָּזֶה[77] **— and in the holy Zohar (Part I, 117a) they hinted regarding this** לְעִנְיַן אֶלֶף הַשִּׁשִּׁי: **— to the sixth millennium:** תַּרְעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא וּמַבּוּעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא לְתַתָּא. **— the gates of wisdom above — and the wellsprings of wisdom below.** וְהַיְינוּ נִבְקְעוּ "כָּל מַעְיְנוֹת תְּהוֹם רַבָּה" **— there burst open 'all the fountains of the great deep'—** שֶׁאָז בִּימֵי הַמַּבּוּל מַבּוּעֵי דְּחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה;[78] **— the wellsprings of**

---

[71] **Chullin 139b**: 'Where is Moses alluded to in the Torah? As it is written: 'For that he also is flesh (be-shaggam), yet his days shall be a hundred and twenty years' (Genesis 6:3)—the numerical value of be-shaggam (345) equals that of Moshe (345). Where is Esther alluded to in the Torah? 'And I will surely hide (haster astir) My face on that day' (Deuteronomy 31:18). Where is Mordechai alluded to in the Torah? It is written: 'Flowing myrrh (mor deror)' (Exodus 30:23), which Onkelos translates as mira dakhya. Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah? 'Have you eaten from the tree (ha-min ha-etz)' (Genesis 3:11).'

[72] **Chullin 139b:10**: "The people of Pappunya asked Rav Mattana: If someone found a bird's nest on a person's head, what is the law concerning sending away the mother bird? He answered them with the verse, 'And earth was upon his head,' treating the head as ground for this purpose. Where is Moshe alluded to in the Torah before his birth? In 'inasmuch as he too is flesh,' be-shaggam hu basar. The numerical value of be-shaggam is that of Moshe."

[73] **Zohar, Pinchas 10:48-58**: 'Zohar III:216a (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna): 'At the time of the Flood, in the six-hundredth year of Noah's life, the generation was potentially fit to receive the Torah, and the soul-root of Moses was present among them—as hinted in "for he also is flesh (beshagach)" (Genesis 6:3), which shares the numerical value of Moshe (345)—had they not corrupted their way upon the earth.'''

[74] **Zohar III 216a**: 'Our Sages further expounded another mystery: 'The generation that departs is the generation that comes'; one who went lame returns lame, and one who went blind returns blind. They also taught that Moshe was destined to receive the Torah in the generation of the Flood; but because they were wicked, Scripture states, 'For he too is flesh' (be-shagam hu basar). 'Be-shagam' is Moshe. Why does it call him 'be-shagam'? Rather, Koheles concealed the matter by omitting the letter beis from 'be-shagam': 'I said that this too (she-gam) is vanity.''''

[75] **Shemot Rabbah 30:13** (excerpt): "'A man of gifts destroys it' refers to the generation of the Flood, who did not administer justice. See what is written of them: 'They drive away the orphan's donkey; they turn the needy from the road' (Job 24:3–4). Rabbi Acha said: The Holy One, blessed be He, sought to give them four things—Torah, suffering, sacrificial service, and prayer—but they did not want them. 'They said to God: Turn away from us' (Job 21:14) refers to suffering. 'We do not desire knowledge of Your ways' refers to Torah. 'What is the Almighty, that we should serve Him?' (Job 21:15) refers to sacrifices. 'What will we gain if we entreat Him?' refers to prayer."

[76] **Genesis 7:11**: 'In the six-hundredth year of Noach's life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month—on that very day all the fountains of the great deep were split open, and the windows of heaven were opened.'

[77] **Zohar, Vayera 30:444-451**: 'The Vau will be multiplied into the He ten times, making sixty, when it will raise the exiles from the dust. At every sixty years of the sixth thousand the He will mount a stage higher, acquiring greater strength. And after six hundred years of the sixth thousand there will be opened the gates of wisdom above and the fountains of wisdom below, and the world will make preparations to enter on the seventh thousand as man makes preparations on the sixth day of the week, when the sun is about to set. As a mnemonic to this we take the verse, "In the six hundredth year of Noah's life… all the fountains of the great deep were broken up" (Gen. 7, 11).'''

[78] **Zohar, Vayera 30:445**: "When Vav is completed within ten six times, they are then sixty, to raise her from the dust. At each successive sixty of that sixth millennium, Hei grows stronger and rises through her levels to gain strength. In the

lower wisdom, the Oral Torah; תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב – "וַאֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמַיִם" **— and 'the windows of heaven'—the gates of wisdom, the Written Torah;** שֶׁאָז הָיוּ רְאוּיִם לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **— for then they were fit to receive the Written Torah** שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל בָּהּ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— within which the entire Oral Torah was enfolded,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁקִּבֵּל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אַחַר כָּךְ מֵהַר סִינַי **— just as Moses our teacher received later from Mount Sinai,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מֹשֶׁה קִבֵּל תּוֹרָה מִסִּינַי וּמְסָרָהּ לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ" **— as stated: 'Moses received Torah from Sinai and transmitted it to Joshua',** דְּקָאֵי עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— which refers to the Oral Torah,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מָסַר לַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי לֵוִי **— for the Written Torah he handed to the priests, the sons of Levi,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, קלז, בְּסְפָרִים אֲחֵרִים).[79] **— as stated in the holy Zohar (Part II, 137, in the variant reading).**

A season's spiritual possibility depends on how its power is used

וּכְתִיב: "וַיְהִי הַגֶּשֶׁם עַל הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם",[80] **— And it is written: 'And the rain was upon the earth forty days',** שֶׁאִם יָשׁוּבוּ יִהְיוּ גִּשְׁמֵי בְרָכָה, כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי **— for He brought them down in mercy** שֶׁהוֹרִידָן בְּרַחֲמִים **— that if they repent, they would be rains of blessing, as Rashi explains;** כְּמוֹ וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה **— which is Torah,** שֶׁאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בָּבָא קַמָּא יז.):[81] **— as brought in the Gemara (Bava Kama 17a):** "אֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה". **— 'Water is nothing other than Torah.'** אַךְ כֵּיוָן שֶׁלֹּא שָׁבוּ וְקִלְקְלוּ **— Yet because they did not repent and corrupted their ways,** נַעֲשׂוּ מַיִם הַזֵּידוֹנִים וְנִשְׁפְּטוּ **— the rains became raging waters, and that generation was judged,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב אַחַר כָּךְ: "וַיְהִי הַמַּבּוּל אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם". **— and as written afterward: 'And the Flood was forty days.'** – "וַהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּתִשְׁרֵי "וַיְהִי אוֹר **— Namely, in Tishrei, 'And there was light'—** דְּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה **— this is Rosh Hashanah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתִּיקוּנִים (תִּיקּוּן לוֹ);[82, 83] **— as stated in the Tikkunim (Tikkun 36);** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה

six-hundredth year of the sixth millennium, the gates of wisdom above and the wellsprings of wisdom below will open, and the world will be prepared to enter the seventh, like a person who prepares on the sixth day, as the sun is setting, to enter the Sabbath. So it is here too. Your sign is: "In the six-hundredth year of Noah's life," and, further in that verse, "all the fountains of the great deep burst open.""

[79] **Zohar II 137b**: 'Moshe wrote this Torah and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi, who carried the Ark of the Covenant of Hashem, and to all the elders of Israel" (Deuteronomy 31:9, translated in full). This is the scriptural statement underlying Rav Tzadok's distinction between the Written Torah entrusted to the priests and the Oral Torah that requires reception and explication.'

[80] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 76:1**: "At the time of a person's failure, he should know that this very time is a preparation for that same matter for good. If he merits it at that moment, he can rise to a very great level. The greatness of the good he can receive then corresponds to the greatness of the sin toward which the inclination entices him—if he turns this longing and desire toward good. The good comes from that very matter, as the opposite of the evil. Thus the Zohar says that at the time of the Flood they were fit to receive Torah, and Moses was then present, as our Sages expounded the word beshaggam; see there. Water means Torah, but they turned it into 'raging waters.' Torah is the ultimate support of the world, for whose sake it was created, yet they caused its destruction. Had they merited it, that time was prepared for the very opposite: the descent of the waters of Torah to sustain the world. Likewise, at the time of the destruction the Messiah was born, as stated in the Jerusalem Talmud. That time was prepared, had they merited it, for the Messiah's coming and the building of the eternal Temple. This was the error of the people of Jerusalem and the false prophets: they thought that, on the contrary, God would do good to them, because they saw that the time was prepared for this—if they merited it."
Tzidkat HaTzadik extends the Flood's unrealized possibility to the individual: a powerful desire can be redirected toward a corresponding good. It also explains the condition in Rav Tzadok's seasonal reading. A time being suited to blessing does not guarantee the result; the final example explicitly identifies the mistake of treating potential as a promise. Accepting the yoke of Torah is the response that the Mar Cheshvan passage calls for.

[81] **Bava Kamma 17a**: 'There is no 'sowing' except tzedakah, as it says, 'Sow for yourselves righteousness and reap according to kindness'; and there is no 'water' except Torah, as it says, 'Ho! Everyone who thirsts, come to the waters.'"

[82] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 36**: 'Two thousand years of chaos: 'The earth was chaos'; two thousand years of Torah: 'The spirit of God was hovering over the surface of the waters'—and 'water' means nothing other than Torah. 'The face of the waters' refers to its two aspects, positive and negative commandments, white and red, right and left. Then come the two thousand years of the days of Mashiach: 'God said: Let there be light, and there was light.' ... 'Let there be light' is Pesach, the light of the fourteenth; 'and there was light' is Rosh Hashanah, of which it is said, 'And there was a day.' Here 'and there was,' and there 'and there was'; wherever 'and there was' occurs it conveys a language of distress."'

[83] **Tikkunei Zohar 77b:4-78a:3**: 'In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 36, 77b), the verse 'Let there be light, and there was light' is expounded on the two heads of the year: 'Let there be light (Yehi Ohr)' refers to Nisan and Passover, when the light of Chesed shines from Above; 'and there was light (Vayehi Ohr)' refers to Tishrei and Rosh Hashanah, when Israel awakens the light of Torah from below through judgment and repentance."'

(פָּרָשַׁת אַחֲרֵי מוֹת):[84] **— and so written in Midrash Rabbah (Parashat Acharei Mot):** ,"אוֹרִי" בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה **— 'My light' on Rosh Hashanah,** ,"תּוֹרָה אוֹר" – שֶׁאָז מַתְחִיל הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **— for then begins renewal in words of Torah—'Torah is light'—** עַד שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת **— until Shemini Atzeret,** ,שֶׁהוּא נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא **— which is the flowing wellspring of Torah,** ,כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתִּיקוּנִים (תִּיקוּן יג)[85, 86] **— as stated in the Tikkunim (Tikkun 13),** ;שֶׁאָז נִקְבָּע אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **— for then the light of the Oral Torah is set, innovation in Torah;** וּמֵאָז הַזְּמַן אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם **— and from then is the forty-day span** לְקַבֵּל הַהַשְׁפָּעָה וְהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה בְּקִבְיעוּת. **— to receive this flow and renewal in Torah permanently.** וְכֵן זְמַן הַגְּשָׁמִים, אִיתָא (תַּעֲנִית ו.):[87, 88] **— And likewise regarding the rainy season, it is taught (Ta'anit 6a):** ,יוֹרֶה בְּמַרְחֶשְׁוָן **— the first rain (Yoreh) falls in Marcheshvan,** ,"יוֹרֶה" – שֶׁמּוֹרֶה אֶת הַבְּרִיּוֹת לְהָטִיחַ וְכוּלֵי **— 'Yoreh'—it instructs (moreh) people to plaster, etc.,** וּמְרַמֵּז גַּם כֵּן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה אֶת הַבְּרִיּוֹת **— and it also alludes to instructing people** לְקַבֵּל עוֹל תּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת. **— to take upon themselves the yoke of Torah in truth.** וְכֵן כָּתַב הַמַּגִּיד מִקָּאזְנִיץ זְצַ"ר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, **— And so wrote the Maggid of Kozhnitz of blessed memory,** דְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֶרֶק קַמָּא דְּתַעֲנִית בְּמַעֲלַת יוֹם הַגְּשָׁמִים **— that what is stated in the first chapter of Ta'anit regarding the stature of the day of rain** קָאֵי עַל שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת שֶׁהוּא נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא **— refers to Shemini Atzeret, which is the wellspring of Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ט). **— (as explained in Bereishit, Discourse 9).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: שֶׁמִּן אוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה עַד שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **— And this is what it meant: that from that hour until Solomon built the Temple** הָיוּ עוֹשִׂין אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם גְּשָׁמִים לְשֶׁם מֵי הַמַּבּוּל, **— they had forty days of rains marking the waters of the Flood;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאִם יִזְכּוּ **— namely, that if they merit—** יוּקְבְּעוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם בְּהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת **— words of Torah become fixed in their hearts with renewal** בְּאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם מִיּוֹם שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת, שֶׁהוּא נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא; **— during the forty days from Shemini Atzeret, which is the wellspring of Torah;** וְאִם לֹא יִזְכּוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם – יִהְיֶה מֵי מַבּוּל, **— and if they do not merit, Heaven forbid, it turns into waters of flood,** עַד שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, **— until Solomon built the Holy Temple,** ,"וּכְתִיב: "כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תוֹרָה וּדְבַר הַשֵּׁם מִירוּשָׁלָם"[89] **— and it is written: 'For out of Zion shall go forth Torah, and the word of Hashem from Jerusalem',** ("דְּבַר הַשֵּׁם" – זוֹ הֲלָכָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (שַׁבָּת קלח:)[90] **— 'the word of Hashem'—this is Halakhah, as stated (Shabbat 138b);** וְשָׁם הָיָה לִשְׁכַּת הַגָּזִית שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ

---

[84] **Vayikra Rabbah 21:4; parallel in Midrash Tehillim 27:3**: 'The Sages expounded the verse in connection with Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur: 'My light'—on Rosh Hashanah; 'my salvation'—on Yom Kippur. 'Of whom shall I fear?' ... 'When evildoers draw near to me'—these are the princes of the nations, who come to accuse Israel before the Holy One. They say: Master of the world, these worship idols and those worship idols; these practice forbidden relations and those practice forbidden relations; these spill blood and those spill blood. Why should these descend to Gehinnom and those not? ... The Accuser has permission to prosecute throughout the year, except on Yom Kippur.'"

[85] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13**: 'Shemini Atzeres is a festival in its own right. In it there is an outflowing spring of Torah, to water the tree that is planted in the Garden. Its roots and branches are like the circle of the earth, in which all the festivals are celebrated.'

[86] **Tikkunei Zohar 29b:3**: "Shemini Atzeres is a festival in its own right. Within it is the wellspring of Torah, watering the tree planted in the garden. Its roots and branches are like the circle of the earth, around which all the festivals revolve."

[87] **Ta'anit 6a**: 'Our Sages taught: 'Yoreh'—because it instructs people to plaster their roofs, to bring their produce indoors, and to make all the other necessary arrangements. Another explanation: because it saturates the earth and waters it down to the depths. Another: because it falls gently and not with force.'"

[88] **Taanit 6a:2-5**: "The Sages taught: Yoreh, the early rain, is so called because it instructs people to plaster their roofs, bring their produce inside, and attend to all their needs. Another explanation: It saturates the earth and waters it down to the deep, as it says, 'Saturate its furrows, settle its ridges; soften it with showers; bless its growth.' Another explanation: Yoreh descends gently rather than in fury. Or does yoreh mean rain that strips off fruit, washes away seeds, and sweeps away trees? Scripture therefore mentions malkosh, the late rain: Just as malkosh brings blessing, so yoreh brings blessing. Or does malkosh mean rain that topples houses, breaks trees, and brings up destructive locusts? Scripture therefore mentions yoreh: Just as yoreh brings blessing, so malkosh brings blessing. How do we know that yoreh itself brings blessing? It is written, 'Children of Zion, rejoice and be glad in the Lord your God, for He has given you the early rain in righteousness, and brought down rain for you, early rain and late rain in the first month.' The Sages taught: Yoreh falls in Mar Cheshvan and malkosh in Nisan. Do you say yoreh in Mar Cheshvan and malkosh in Nisan, or perhaps yoreh in Tishrei and malkosh in Iyar? Scripture teaches, 'In its season.'"

[89] **Isaiah 2:3**: "Many peoples will go and say: 'Come, let us go up to the mountain of Hashem, to the house of the God of Yaakov. He will teach us of His ways, and we will walk in His paths.' For Torah will go forth from Zion, and the word of Hashem from Jerusalem."

[90] **Shabbat 138b:11**: "'The word of the Lord' means halachah; 'the word of the Lord' means the appointed end of exile; 'the word of the Lord' means prophecy."

יוֹצְאָה תּוֹרָה לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל (סַנְהֶדְרִין פו:);[91] — **and there sat the Chamber of Hewn Stone whence Torah issued to all Israel (Sanhedrin 86b);** וְאָז נִתְגַּלָּה לִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם כָּל חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה – חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה, **and then there was revealed to King Solomon all lower wisdom of the Oral Torah—the wisdom of Solomon,** וּבִקֵּשׁ רַחֲמִים עֲלֵיהֶם וּפָסְקוּ, **and he prayed for mercy upon them and they ceased,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְגִשְׁמֵי בְרָכָה, הַשְׁפָּעָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה. וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ: חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מוֹנִין לַמַּבּוּל כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר,[92] — **transforming into rains of blessing, an influx of Torah. And this is what they said: the Sages reckon for the Flood according to Rabbi Eliezer,** שֶׁאַף שֶׁהָעוֹלָם נִבְרָא בְּנִיסָן — **for even though the physical world was created in Nisan,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם זְמַן הַשְׁפָּעַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁהֵם מֵי הַמַּבּוּל כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין וְנַעֲשִׂים גִּשְׁמֵי בְרָכָה, — **nonetheless the season for the influx of Torah, which are the Flood waters when merited and transformed into rains of blessing,** הַשְׁפָּעָה בְּנִבְיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְתָא, — **an influx from the wellspring of Torah,** וְעַל זֶה הַזְּמַן בְּחֶשְׁוָן כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר. — **is fixed in Cheshvan according to Rabbi Eliezer.**

Restraint makes a vessel for rain to become blessing

וְהַזְּמַן בְּחֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן לְקַבֵּל עָלָיו עוֹל תּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת,[93, 94] — **And the task in the month of Marcheshvan is to assume the yoke of Torah in truth;** וְעִיקַּר עוֹל תּוֹרָה הוּא בְּלִימּוּד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **and the essence of the yoke of Torah is in the study of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ צַעַר גָּדוֹל וְנִידּוּד שֵׁינָה, — **which entails great exertion and sleepless nights,** וּמִי שֶׁאוֹהֵב עוֹשֶׁר וְתַעֲנוּג אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לִלְמוֹד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and one who covets wealth and pleasure cannot master the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג).[95] — **as is stated (Tanchuma, Noach 3).** וּתְנַן: "כָּל הַמְקַבֵּל עָלָיו עוֹל תּוֹרָה – מַעֲבִירִין מִמֶּנּוּ וְכוּלַי"; — **And we learned: 'Whoever accepts upon himself the yoke of Torah—they remove from him, etc.';** וְעַל כֵּן רוֹב הַגְּזֵירוֹת בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה, — **and therefore most harsh decrees threaten in this month,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיְּקַבְּלוּ הַתּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת, — **so that people will embrace the Torah in truth;** וְיִהְיוּ הַמַּיִם גִּשְׁמֵי בְרָכָה מִנְּבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְתָא, כָּאָמוּר: — **and the waters will become rains of blessing from the wellspring of Torah, as stated.**

---

[91] **Sanhedrin 86b:18**: "If the lower courts do not know the answer, both parties come to the Great Court in the Chamber of Hewn Stone, from which Torah goes forth to all Israel, as it says, 'From that place which the Lord will choose.' If the elder returns to his town and continues studying and teaching as he previously did, he is exempt from punishment. But if he rules that people should act against the Great Court's decision, he is liable, as it says, 'The man who acts willfully.' He is liable only when he issues a ruling for practical action."

[92] **Rosh Hashanah 11b, recalled later in Marcheshvan**: 'The Sages of Israel reckon the Flood according to Rabbi Eliezer, and the seasons according to Rabbi Yehoshua.'

[93] **Pirkei Avot 3:5**: 'Rabbi Nechunyah ben HaKanah says: Whoever takes upon himself the yoke of Torah has the yoke of government and the yoke of worldly occupation removed from him. Whoever casts off the yoke of Torah has the yoke of government and the yoke of worldly occupation imposed upon him.'

[94] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 55:2**: "From His side, the blessed God constantly pours forth every kind of blessing and good kindness, as it says, 'The earth is full of the Lord's kindness.' The person, however, may lack a vessel to receive it, for the principal matter depends on the person's vessel. If a person restrains himself in receiving God's abundance, avoiding unbounded expansion with it and instead entrusting it to God, then God correspondingly limits His abundance so that it does not spread beyond the person's vessel; consequently it is blessing. Thus the Sages ask why rain is called an expression of might: because it descends with force. God limits it so that it goes only where needed. But if a person expands himself with God's abundance and does not recognize that God gave it to him, the abundance likewise spreads into wilderness and desolation, into alien places, and consequently becomes a curse. Even concerning the Flood generation, the Midrash says that if they had returned, the rain would have been rain of blessing. Because they expanded themselves without restraint in His abundance, God correspondingly expanded His abundance, and it became rain of curse. Yet from God's side, God forbid, no curse ever arises, only blessing."
Sod Yesharim supplies a mechanism for the change from destructive waters to useful rain. Restraint and recognition of the Giver make the recipient capable of receiving abundance within a fitting measure. This illuminates why Rav Tzadok joins the promise of rain to the yoke and exertion of Torah: disciplined reception gives the flow a form in which it can become blessing.

[95] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:4**: "The Israelites did not accept the Torah until the Holy One, blessed be He, arched the mountain over them like a vessel, as it is said: And they stood beneath the mountain (Exod. 19:17). R. Dimi the son of Hama stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: If you accept the Torah, well and good; but if not, your grave will be there. If you should say that He arched the mountain over them because of the Written Law, isn't it true that as soon as He said to them, "Will you accept the Torah?" they all responded, "We will do and hear," because the Written Law was brief and required no striving and suffering, but rather He threatened them because of the Oral Law. After all, it contains the detailed explanations of the commandments, both simple and difficult, and it is as severe as death, and as jealous as Sheol. One does not study the Oral Law unless he loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, with all his soul, and with all his might, as it is said: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, with all thy soul, and with all thy might (Deut. 6:5)."

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: — **In Sefer Yetzirah:** "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נו"ן בְּרֵיחַ וְכוּלֵי וְחֶשְׁוָן בַּנֶּפֶשׁ וְכוּלֵי".[96] — **"He made the letter Nun rule over smell, etc., and Cheshvan in the year, and the small intestines in the person, etc."** וּבְפֵירוּשׁ הָרַאֲבַ"ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, — **And in the commentary of the Ra'avad of blessed memory,** כְּשֶׁחָשַׁב שְׁנֵים חָשַׁב רֵיחַ כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים, — **when he correlated twelve faculties against twelve tribes,** שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁעָמַד בְּנִסָּיוֹן יָצָא רֵיחוֹ מִסּוֹף הָעוֹלָם וְעַד סוֹפוֹ, עַיֵּן שָׁם, יוֹסֵף, — **for when he withstood temptation his fragrance spread from one end of the world to the other, see there, he linked smell with Joseph,** וְלֹא בֵּאֵר הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ. — **yet he did not explain the underlying root.** "וְהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת ה'": וְנִרְאֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר[97] — **And it appears based on the verse: 'And he shall discern through the fear of Hashem,'** וּבְיוֹסֵף כְּתִיב: "אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא". — **and regarding Joseph it is written: 'I fear God.'** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (עֵירוּבִין כא:): "הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ' – אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא".[98, 99] — **And this is what the Gemara stated (Eruvin 21b): '"The mandrakes yield fragrance'—these are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the flavor of sin."** וּמִלְּשׁוֹן "בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל" נִרְאֶה דְּקָאֵי עַל פְּגָם זֶה — **And from the phrase 'young men of Israel' it indicates this specific blemish (immorality)** שֶׁתַּיְלְדוּת וְהַבַּחֲרוּת גּוֹרֵם; — **which childhood and youth tend to cause;** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא סוֹטָה (מט.): "מוֹרַחְנָא רֵיחָא דַּחֲנִינְתָא, אֲמַר לֵיהּ: בְּנִי, טָהֲרָה יֵשׁ בָּךְ".[100, 101] — **and so it is brought in the Gemara, Sotah (49a): 'I smell the scent of hanunita (a fragrant fruit)'; he said to him: 'My son, you possess purity.'** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת ה'", וּכְתִיב: "יִרְאַת ה' טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד". — **And this too is based upon: 'And he shall discern through the fear of Hashem,' and it is written: 'The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever.'** וּכְשֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ חוּשׁ הָרֵיחַ בִּשְׁלֵימוּת — **And when one possesses the olfactory sense in perfection,** מוֹרֶה שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ יִרְאָה וְטָהֳרָה, — **it demonstrates that he possesses fear of God and purity,** וְעַל כֵּן נֶאֱמַר עַל הַטָּהוֹרִים מִפְּגָם זֶה: "הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ".[102] — **and therefore it was declared concerning those untainted by this blemish: 'The mandrakes yield fragrance.'** וְאָמַר "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נו"ן בְּרֵיחַ", — **And it said,**

---

[96] **Sefer Yetzirah, Gra Version 5:9 — complete relevant comparison**: 'He made the letter nun king over scent and bound a crown to it, and combined them one with the other; and with them He formed Scorpio in the world, Cheshvan in the year, and the intestines in the person, male and female. He made the letter samekh king over sleep, bound a crown to it, and combined them; and with them He formed Sagittarius in the world, Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the person, male and female.'

[97] **Isaiah 11:3**: 'He will be imbued with the fear of Hashem; he will not judge by what his eyes see, and he will not decide by what his ears hear.'

[98] **Eruvin 21b, quoting Song of Songs 7:14**: 'The mandrakes give forth fragrance: these are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin.'

[99] **Eruvin 21b**: "Rava expounded: What is meant by 'The mandrakes have given forth fragrance'? These are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin."

[100] **Sotah 49a — the scent of purity**: 'From the time Rabbi Meir died, the composers of parables ceased ... Purity took away taste and fragrance." Rav Huna found a fragrant date, took it, and wrapped it in his cloth. Rabbah his son came and said: "I smell the fragrance of the fragrant date." Rav Huna said: "My son, there is purity in you," and gave it to him. Meanwhile, his grandson Abba arrived; Rabbah took it and gave it to him. Rav Huna said: "My son, you have gladdened my heart and set my teeth on edge."'

[101] **Sotah 49a:10**: "Rav Huna found a fragrant hinunita date, took it, and wrapped it in his kerchief. His son Rabbah came and said to him: 'I smell the fragrance of hinunita.' He said: 'My son, you have purity in you,' and gave it to him. Meanwhile Abba, Rabbah's son, came; Rabbah took it and gave it to him. Rav Huna said: 'My son, you have gladdened my heart and blunted my teeth.' This is what people say: A father's love is for his children; the children's love is for their own children."

[102] **Peri Tzadik, Bo 4:1**: "This accords with what was said (Eruvin 21b): "The mandrakes have given fragrance"—these are the young men of Israel who have not tasted sin. We have already said that the expression "young men of Israel" indicates that "sin" here means a blemish of the covenant, to which youth and early life give rise. Since they have not tasted this sin, they give a good fragrance. Conversely, one who causes such a blemish, Heaven forbid, has a repulsive odor. Hence the inclination toward desire is called "this repulsive one," for it is repellent and repulsive, as was said (Shabbat 151a), "A woman is a skin-bottle," etc. Concerning this they said (Sukkah 52b): "If this repulsive one encounters you, draw him to the study hall"—draw the desire so that it becomes delight in the teaching and love of Torah, as it will be in the future, as stated in Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar I, 138a)."